desperate, as we played out time, for that goal—my goal—to be the one that took us to Wembley.

My mum and dad were sitting up in the stand and, at full-time, I looked up towards them and felt the tears welling up inside of me. Wembley held so many memories for us, going back as far as the first time Dad took me. I can still remember going to a schoolboy international one Saturday afternoon when I was only seven and having to stand on my seat to be able to see. Dad kept telling me to get down. I kept getting back up. Eventually, the seat gave way and I fell and knocked out my two front teeth. There was blood everywhere and Dad had to take me home.

Wembley always meant the Cup Final, too: we were there for that amazing 3–3 draw between United and Crystal Palace in 1990, which had every bit of drama you could hope for, with Ian Wright coming on as a substitute and almost winning them the game. I remember not being able to go to the replay because it was a school night and I was going mad at home, jumping off the settee and dancing round the front room, when Lee Martin scored the winner. Every time United got to a final, I'd hang a flag in my bedroom window, with a picture of Bryan Robson stuck next to it, so everybody could see from the street who I supported. I don't know who said it first, but it's true: kids don't dream about playing for a team that wins the League. Every schoolboy's dream is about playing in the Cup Final. As we celebrated at Villa Park, I knew—and my parents knew—that dream was about to come true.

Wembley was six weeks away and we had Premiership games we had to win but, in the back of my mind, was the thought that I had to stay fit and keep playing well enough to make sure I was in the team against Liverpool. As it turned out, it was close. Steve Bruce told me later that the manager had been thinking, just before the final, about leaving me out. Liverpool played with three center-halves and the boss and Steve and the coaching staff met to talk about matching their shape—playing with wing-backs—which would have meant I'd have been on the bench. At the time, and I'm glad about it, I didn't know any of that. All I had to think about was beating Liverpool and doing the Double.

For me, the FA Cup Final had always seemed like a very special occasion. It was for the club I was playing for, too. Manchester United have been in more finals—and won more of them—than anyone else. The club and the manager knew how to do it in style. We traveled down to London a couple of days before the game, all fitted out in new suits, and stayed at a lovely hotel